zamindars.[206] Hearing of the troubles, Pandithurai Thevar sent his agent to examine the accounts of the company. Apparently, he was prepared to advance more money to acquire another ship.[207]

'We found in the first two years that it [running the company] was quite practicable, though very difficult. We were able to collect money, not only capital but also sell shares enough to keep us going.'[208] But that was not enough. SSNCo took recourse to issuing frantic appeals in the press. Asserting that SSNCo was not merely of local importance, it said, 'It had become *an all-Indian concern*. *Its failure will be a national disaster*, a block in the way of all further National enterprise. Its success on the other hand will be a sure foundation for National prosperity.'[209]